

An overview of the GV499 Dissertation Process

Term	Date	Event
Autumn Term (Wks 7-11)	Varies by Programme	Programme-specific Introductory Dissertation Sessions. Each MSc programme will organise an introductory workshop offering basic guidance on dissertation research. PPA and Regulation workshops take place within GV4E9 and GV488 core courses.
Autumn Term (Wk 10)	Wednesday, 3 December 2025 (4-6pm) and Thursday, 4 December 2025 (2-4pm)	Department of Government Dissertation Sessions: these sessions will focus on the overall process and timeline for the dissertation and the key aspects of research design and methodology. Students should sign-up for one of these sessions: details will be provided by the MSc Programmes Support team.
Winter Term (Wks 1-5)	Monday 19 January - Friday 20 February 2026	Students are encouraged to discuss dissertations with their academic mentors in the early Winter Term (January-February) and to consider potential dissertation supervisors.
Winter Term (Wks 2-4)	Varies by Programme	Second Dissertation Session
Winter Term (Wk 5)	Friday 20 February 2026	Submission of Dissertation Supervisor Request Form. Students will be invited to complete a Dissertation Supervision Form via Moodle, due by the end of week 5. This form will ask students for a very brief outline of their dissertation topic and possible research question to assist in matching students to appropriate supervisors. The allocations will be confirmed via email in Week 6.
Winter Term (Wk 6)	Friday 27 February 2026	Allocation of Dissertation Supervisors. Students are expected to start meeting regularly with their allocated dissertation supervisor in preparation for the submission of the formal dissertation prospectus late March. Please speak to your supervisor about this early on.
Winter Term (Wk 11)	Monday 30 March 2026	Deadline for submission of dissertation prospectus of around 1000 words. The prospectus is an outline of the dissertation plan. Please speak to your supervisor about this early on.
Winter Term / Spring Term	Monday 2 March - Friday 15 May 2026	Students are expected to continue to meet with their dissertation supervisor following the submission of their prospectus, in order to discuss the key points mentioned in their prospectus and agree the topic and approach for their dissertation, in preparation for the submission of the Dissertation Topic Approval form.
Spring Term	Friday 15 May 2026	Deadline for submission of the Dissertation Topic Approval form. In this form, students will be asked to confirm that they have agreed the topic and the approach for their dissertation with their supervisor and to enter the agreed title of their dissertation.
Spring Term	Friday 15 May – Friday 19 June 2026	Following the submission of the Dissertation Topic Approval form, students are expected to continue to discuss the development of their dissertation proposal with their supervisors until the end of formal dissertation supervision at the end of the Spring Term.
Spring Term (Wks 1-7)	Tuesday 5 May - Friday 19 June 2026	LSE LIFE runs a series of dissertation workshops in the Spring Term. Students can sign up via the LSE Training and Development System.
Summer Time	Monday 22 June - Friday 31 July 2026	Following the end of the Spring Term, dissertation supervisors will run two dissertation support windows for their supervisees during the summer months. The dates will be confirmed by your supervisor by the end of the Spring Term.
Summer Time	Monday 23 June - Friday 7 August 2026	Dissertation Support Sessions will run throughout the summer. Provision will also be made for quantitative support. We will contact students about availability by the end of the Spring Term.
Summer Time	Tuesday 18 August 2026	Dissertation submission deadline.